A Compelling Appendix

A personal word, a public word, and a parting word — and the last word is grace.

Where this study fits

The Epistle to Philemon · three studies · this study highlighted

01 Philemon 1–7

A Cautious Approach

Greetings · Grace and Peace · Gratitude · Gladness

02 Philemon 8–19

A Comprehensive Appeal

Necessity · Responsibility · Liability

03 Philemon 20–25

A Compelling Appendix

A Personal Word · A Public Word · A Parting Word

Study 3 closes the letter: Paul says goodbye — and the last word is grace.

A compelling appendix, verse by verse

Philemon 20–25 · the commentary's outline

v.20	**I.A Provide me relief — rejoice me, refresh me in the Lord**	*ὀναίμην · σπλάγχνα*
v.21	**I.B Prove me right — simple and superlative obedience**	*ὑπακοή · ὑπέρ*
v.22	**I.C Prepare me a room — plan on it; pray for it**	*ξενία*
v.23	**II.A Greeting from the man in prison with Paul — Epaphras**	*συναιχμάλωτος*
v.24	**II.B Greetings from the men in partnership — Mark, Aristarchus, Demas, Luke**	*συνεργοί*
v.25	**III. A Parting Word — grace be with your spirit**	*χάρις*

The personal word

Philemon 20–22 · Commentary I

Provide me relief
v. 20

- “I want to profit from you” — in the Lord
- “I” and “you” emphatic: the order reversed
- Refresh my σπλάγχνα — see my two sons together

Prove me right
v. 21

- Simple: “having confidence in your obedience”
- Superlative: “even more than I say”
- The second mile (Matt. 5:39–41)

Prepare me a room
v. 22

- Plan on it — Paul expected release
- Pray for it — out of jail, and over there
- Implication: I’ll be there to see

People don’t always do what you expect; they do what you inspect.

Mark: the rest of the story

Philemon 24 · Commentary II.B.1

1

Before

The young man who fled naked (Mark 14:51–52) — courageous, running to warn Jesus

An interpretation

2

The failure

Quit in the middle of the first missionary journey

3

After

“Welcome him” (Col. 4:10); “useful to me for ministry” (2 Tim. 4:11)

4

Now

“My fellow laborer” — and “Mark my son” with Peter (1 Pet. 5:13)

One failure — but look at all the success before and after. Failure is neither fatal nor final.

Fellow prisoners and fellow laborers

Philemon 23–24 · Commentary II

Epaphras
fellow prisoner

- “One of you” — from Colossae
- Laboring fervently in prayer
- Burden for Laodicea and Hierapolis

Aristarchus
fellow laborer

- Took the fall in the Ephesian riot (Acts 19:29)
- With Paul to Rome (Acts 27:2)
- Fellow prisoner (Col. 4:10)

Demas
fellow laborer

- “My fellow laborer” — for now
- Later: “Demas has forsaken me” (2 Tim. 4:10)

Luke
fellow laborer

- The beloved physician
- “Only Luke is with me” (2 Tim. 4:11)
- Faithful to the end

If we put ourselves in that picture, we could be brought to tears for Paul.

The parting word: grace

Philemon 25 · Commentary III

Saving grace
by grace, through faith

- Salvation by grace, through faith
- Only the beginning

Sharing grace
2 Corinthians 8:1–7

- Macedonians gave beyond their ability
- “Please take my money!”
- Giving is a grace, not a chore

Serving grace
Hebrews 12:28

- “Let us hold fast to grace”
- We can’t serve God by keeping the law

“The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit.” One little word — but it could not be more important if it were a whole book.

Discuss and apply

Philemon 20–25 · from the study's questions and applications

Discuss

1. Who has put confidence in you that you need to prove right this week?
2. What failure in your past have you treated as fatal or final?
3. Is your giving and serving a chore — or a grace?

Apply

Go the Extra Mile

Go a second mile with one obligation this week.

Neither Fatal nor Final

Welcome someone who has failed, as Paul did Mark.

Hold Fast to Grace

Give or serve this week as a privilege, not a chore.

In one line: See you here, there, or in the air — one day, no more parting.